Nareija Najma T. Tanggol

Nareija Najma T. Tanggol is a Filipina Bangsamoro metallurgical engineer, researcher, and youth advocate who built her reputation at the intersection of sustainable science and Muslim student leadership.

A graduate of the University of the Philippines Diliman (UP Diliman), she is best known for her research on recovering silver from industrial waste using eco-friendly chemical methods, and for her service as President of the UP Muslim Students' Association (UP MSA), where she pushed for better spaces and support for Muslim students on campus.

Her story is one of quiet but meaningful trailblazing: a young Bangsamoro woman carving a place in the sciences while making sure her community doesn't get left behind in the halls of the country's national university.

She passed the PRC Metallurgical Engineers Licensure Examination in October 2023, and currently works as a Metallurgist and Raw Materials Analyst.

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Background

Nareija Najma T. Tanggol grew up as part of the Bangsamoro community, bringing with her the values of faith, community, and perseverance that define much of Muslim Filipino life.

Her early academic path led her to the University of the Philippines Integrated School (UPIS), where she completed her secondary education and graduated in 2017.

From early on, she showed a clear aptitude for the sciences, a direction that would shape the rest of her academic and professional journey.

Education

After UPIS, Tanggol enrolled at University of the Philippines Diliman and pursued a degree in Metallurgical Engineering, a highly technical field that combines chemistry, physics, and engineering in the study of metals and materials.

It's not the most common path, and it's an even rarer one for Muslim women in the Philippines, but Tanggol committed to it fully.

Beyond the classroom, she got involved in campus life in meaningful ways.

She was a member of the **UP Delta Lambda Sigma Sorority**, building a network of sisterhood alongside her engineering coursework.

She also joined the **UP Mining, Metallurgical, and Materials Engineering Association** (UP MMMIEA), where she took on the role of Finance Committee Head, showing early signs of her organizational skills and leadership instincts.

Career and Professional Milestones

In October 2023, Tanggol passed the **Metallurgical Engineers Licensure Examination** administered by the Professional Regulation Commission (PRC), officially becoming a licensed Metallurgical Engineer in the Philippines.

That's no small feat. The board exam covers a demanding range of technical topics, and passing it opens doors to formal practice in one of engineering's more specialized disciplines.

After licensure, she moved into professional practice as a **Metallurgist and Raw Materials Analyst**, applying her expertise to the quality assessment and processing of minerals in an industrial setting.

She also holds certification as a **Basic Occupational Safety and Health (BOSH) Officer 2**, which reflects her commitment to workplace safety standards on top of her technical work.

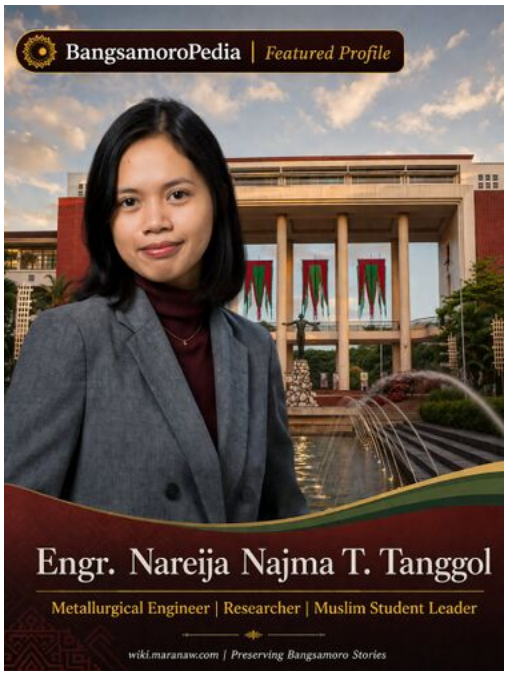
Research and Academic Contributions

Tanggol's undergraduate research landed squarely in **hydrometallurgy**, the branch of metallurgy that uses aqueous chemistry to extract and recover metals.

Her signature study, co-authored during her time at UP Diliman, is titled *"Silver Recovery from Waste Radiographic Film Using Oxalic Acid."*

The research tackled a practical and timely problem: what do you do with discarded X-ray films, which contain metallic silver, once they've served their medical purpose?

Nareija Najma T. Tanggol



Nationality	Filipino
Ethnicity	Bangsamoro (Maranao)
Religion	Islam
Education	B.S. Metallurgical Engineering, University of the Philippines Diliman
Secondary Education	UP Integrated School (UPIS), Class of 2017
Profession	Metallurgical Engineer, Researcher, Youth Leader
Licensure	PRC Metallurgical Engineers Licensure Examination (October 2023)
Notable Role	President, UP Muslim Students' Association (UP MSA)

Tanggol and her collaborators explored the use of chemical stripping, specifically oxalic acid, to extract silver microparticles from these films.

Research Focus	Hydrometallurgy, Sustainable Resource Recovery
Certification	BOSH Officer 2 (Basic Occupational Safety and Health)

The method they investigated offered a lower-cost and less toxic alternative to conventional recovery techniques, which often rely on harsh chemicals and produce significant hazardous byproducts.

Her work also extended into the **optimization of chemical stripping parameters**, contributing to the growing body of literature on sustainable chemistry and circular economy applications in the Philippine context.

In plain terms: her research looks at how to turn waste into something useful, and how to do it in a way that's less harmful to people and the environment.

That kind of work matters particularly in a country still developing its capacity for responsible industrial waste management.

Institutional Contributions and Leadership

Perhaps the part of Tanggol's story that resonates most broadly is her leadership within the Muslim student community at UP Diliman.

She served as **President of the UP Muslim Students' Association (UP MSA)**, one of the most visible Muslim student organizations at the country's premier state university.

In that role, she became a voice for Muslim students navigating academic life in an environment that isn't always fully set up to accommodate their needs.

One of the causes she championed was the **campaign for dedicated prayer spaces** on the UP Diliman campus.

For Muslim students who pray five times a day, access to a clean and appropriate space for prayer is not a luxury. It's a basic religious requirement, and the absence of dedicated facilities was a real inconvenience that Tanggol and the MSA worked to address.

Under her watch, the UP MSA also carried out community welfare programs, including **Iftar meal drives** during Ramadan and the **distribution of hygiene kits** to Muslim communities in need, including those in detention centers.

These weren't just symbolic gestures. They reflected a leadership style that combined advocacy with direct, tangible service to the community.

Cultural Significance and Values

Tanggol represents something important in the broader picture of Bangsamoro representation in Philippine society.

She's part of a growing generation of Muslim Filipino professionals who are not choosing between their faith and their fields but are instead showing up fully in both.

Her presence in a demanding STEM discipline like metallurgical engineering, combined with her active role in Muslim student advocacy, sends a clear message: Bangsamoro women belong in every space, including the ones that have historically been hard to access.

Her research values sustainability and her leadership values inclusivity. Both of those orientations reflect a broader commitment to a more just and responsible society, values that are deeply embedded in Islamic teaching and in Bangsamoro cultural identity.

Recognition

Tanggol's accomplishments include passing one of the more challenging professional licensure examinations in the engineering field, earning recognition as a licensed Metallurgical Engineer registered with the PRC.

Her research on silver recovery has been made available through academic platforms, including her **Academia.edu** profile, making her work accessible to the broader research community.

Her leadership of the UP MSA brought her into public view as an advocate, including through media coverage of the prayer space campaign that highlighted the needs of Muslim students in the UP system.

Challenges

Tanggol's path was not without its hurdles.

Metallurgical Engineering is a demanding discipline with a small student population, and as a Muslim woman in that space, she navigated environments where people who look like her are rarely the norm.

The campaign for prayer spaces at UP Diliman, which she helped lead, also points to a broader challenge: even in a national university that prides itself on diversity, Muslim students often have to advocate loudly for accommodations that students of other faiths take for granted.

Her story is therefore not only one of personal achievement but also a quiet commentary on the work still needed to make Philippine higher education genuinely inclusive for all communities.

See Also

- Metallurgical Engineering in the Philippines
- University of the Philippines Diliman
- UP Muslim Students' Association
- Bangsamoro professionals in STEM
- Institute of Islamic Studies, UP Diliman

References

- UP Diliman Academia.edu profile of Nareija Najma T. Tanggol
- Professional Regulation Commission (PRC), Metallurgical Engineers Licensure Examination, October 2023
- UP MSA Facebook page: https://www.facebook.com/upmsadiliman/
- Kule.org article on Muslim students and prayer spaces at UP Diliman

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